

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Cumaravelu Balakumar

Address: 6 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Re: Objection to Planning Application for Change of Use - Former Ambulance Station to Community Space and Prayer Facility

I am writing to register my objection to the proposed change of use of the former ambulance station to a community facility incorporating a prayer area. My concerns relate to material planning considerations, including parking provision, highway safety, the site's proximity to a local school, and the impact on residential amenity.

1. Parking Capacity and Existing Pressure

The site is located in an area where onstreet parking is already heavily constrained. The proposal does not demonstrate that sufficient offstreet parking will be provided to meet the likely demand generated by a community venue and prayer facility.

The surrounding streets regularly experience congestion, and I have personally witnessed irresponsible and obstructive parking during busy periods.

A development of this nature is likely to attract visitors at peak times, increasing pressure on an already saturated parking environment.

The suggestion that visitors may rely on bicycles or alternative transport modes is not practical given the nature of attendance patterns, group visits, and the demographic likely to use the facility.

2. Proximity to the School and Conflict with School Timings

The site is situated very close to a local school, creating a significant conflict with existing traffic flows.

School pickup and dropoff times already generate substantial congestion, with parents parking along surrounding roads and manoeuvring in tight spaces.

Additional vehicle movements associated with the proposed use-particularly around late afternoons-would intensify this congestion and increase risks to child safety.

The cumulative impact of school traffic and visitors to the proposed facility has not been adequately assessed.

3. Highway Safety Concerns

The combination of increased traffic, limited visibility in surrounding streets, and high pedestrian activity (including children) raises serious highway safety concerns.

The proposal does not provide evidence that the local road network can safely accommodate the additional vehicle movements.

Increased instances of illegal or unsafe parking-already observed in the area-would likely worsen.

4. Noise and Disturbance

A community and prayer facility has the potential to generate significant noise, particularly during peak attendance times or evening events.

The proposal does not include a robust noise impact assessment.

The surrounding area is predominantly residential, and increased noise levels would negatively affect local amenity.

5. Incompatibility with Surrounding Land Use

The former ambulance station operated with predictable, controlled vehicle movements. The proposed use represents a substantial intensification of activity.

The scale and nature of the proposed use are not compatible with the quiet residential character of the area.

The application does not demonstrate that the development would avoid adverse impacts on neighbouring properties.